Holy Trinity University

Course Outline

Theology of Ethiopian Church Fathers

Instructor: Behailu Bekele

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1. Course Description:

This course examines the theological teachings of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church Fathers, exploring how their beliefs have shaped the doctrinal tradition of the Church. We will investigate into the rich heritage of Ethiopian Orthodox theology, analyzing the contributions of key figures and their interpretations of Scripture and tradition.

2. Course Objectives:

- Analyze the contributions of significant Ethiopian Church Fathers to Christian theology.
- Evaluate novel theological ideas in light of the Ethiopian Orthodox tradition.
- Explain the core doctrines of the Ethiopian Orthodox faith using appropriate theological terminology.
- Distinguish key doctrines from heretical beliefs condemned by Church Councils.
- Discuss the main doctrinal issues faced by the Ethiopian Orthodox Church throughout history.
- Develop skills for theological research, analysis, and communication.

3. Learning Outcomes:

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Apply the theological principles of the Ethiopian Orthodox Church to spiritual development and liturgical life.
- Articulate and apply the Ethiopian Orthodox perspective on religious doctrine to ministry and service within and outside the church.
- Demonstrate a deep understanding of the key figures and texts of Ethiopian Orthodox theology.
- Engage in critical analysis of theological concepts and debates.

4. Course Schedule:

Week	Topic
1.	Introduction, Ethiopian Orthodox Theology and her Patristic usage, including a Historical Background
2.	The Ethiopian Orthodox Church Divine Liturgy and Theology **በኢትዮጵያ ኦርቶዶክስ ተዋህዶ ቤተክርስቲያን ሥርዓተ ቅዳሴ ውስጥ ያሉ የሥነ መለኮት ዕይታዎች** Some illustration and expression of theology from 7 Divine liturgyies The other theologies from 7 divine liturgy will be fulfilled with individual assignment
3.	Ethiopian Orthodox Theology and Practice Doctrinal Issues: Explore specific theological doctrines as understood by Ethiopian Orthodox theologians. And a review of the letter of Claudius and **ጦማረ ገላውዴዎስ ወጸሎተ ሃይማኖት ዘአፍራቂያ**
4.	Theology of Ethiopian fathers concerning on the arch of the covenant and the Icon A text in defense of Tabots and icons **በእንተ ሥዕል ወታቦት**
5.	The Holy Trinity: Doctrine and Ethiopian Fathers' Teachings **ትምህርተ ሥላሴ እመዝገበ ሃይማኖት ወዜና ሥላሴ እም ዘርዐያዕቆብ**
6.	Christology: Saint Yared's Teaching on Soteriology and Incarnation, Christology in the Ethiopian Orthodox Church The Incarnation, Christ's Sacrifice for the Salvation of Humanity, The Resurrection and Ascension
7.	Homily of Athanasius Arch bishop of Alexandria on Incarnation of God. **ድርሳን ዘአትናቲዮስ ሊቀ ጳጳሳት ዘእስክንድርያ በእንተ ተሠግዎቱ ለእግዚአብሔር ቃል**
8.	Giving a group Assignment on Christological Controversies in the Ethiopian Church

	And Mid Exam
9.	Christology Continued: Miaphysite Christology in defence of Tewahedo review of one Ancient Amharic version which is written in time of Ras Wube **ነገረ ተዋህዶ በመልአከ ብርሃን አድማሱ ጀምበሬ ፣ በዶክተር ቀሲስ መብራቱ ኪሮስ ፣ በራስ ውቤ ዘመን የተጻፈ እና ነገረ ተዋህዶ በሊቀ ሥልጣናት ሀብተማርያም ወርቅነህ የተጻፈ** And an article written by Liqe Siltanat Habtemariam Workrnrh on Incarnation; and Incarnation of St. Athanasius Teaching And Dr. Fr. Mebratu K. Gebru book of Miapysite Christology
10.	The Holy Spirit: Pneumatology of Ethiopian Fathers The Nicene- Constantinopolitan Creed: Historical analysis and Review in Ethiopian context **ነገረ መንፈስ ቅዱስ እና ጸሎተ ሃይማኖት ከኒቂያ እስከ ቁስጥንጥንያ በኢትዮጵያ ሊቃውንት**
11.	Heresies and theological debates in Ethiopia **በኢትዮጵያ የተነሱ መናፍቃንና የነገረ መለኮት ክርክሮች** **እስጢፋኖሳዊያን** Stephanites **ኤዎስጣቴዎሳዊያን** the ewostatewosites **ሚካኤላዊያን** the mikaelites
12.	Eschatology: The Second Coming of Jesus Christ in Ethiopian Orthodox study **በእንተ ዳግም ምጽአቱ ለእግዚእነ እም መጽሐፈ ርቱዐ ሃይማኖት ወእመጽሐፈ ምሥጢር**
13.	Quiz and giving Individual Assignment on Sacraments and Ecclesiology teaching of Ethiopian fathers in Veneration of Saints and the Holy Virgin Mary
14.	Holy Virgin Mary in Ethiopian orthodox understanding Her theotokia, her perpetual virginity, her intersession, her participation in

	human salvific History **በእንተ ድንግል ማርያም ወምሳሌያተ እግዝእትነ**
15.	Discussion class on the general topic of **Ethiopian Orthodox Theology in the Modern World** **The sub topics will be** A. Challenges and Opportunities: Examine the challenges and opportunities facing the Ethiopian Orthodox Church in the contemporary world. B. Ecumenical Relations: Discuss the Ethiopian Orthodox Church's involvement in ecumenical dialogues and its relationship with other Christian denominations. C. Social and Political Engagement: Explore the Ethiopian Orthodox Church's role in social and political issues.
16.	Presentation of a Group Assignment A. **ጥንተ አብሶ ጉባኤ ኤፌሶን** B. **ጥንተ አብሶ አቀባና አንጽሐ** C. **ቅብዐት** D. **ጸጋ** E. **ሥስት ልደት**

5. Evaluation:

- **Writing Paper on Selected Readings (10%)**
- **Mid-Term Quiz (20%)**
- **Group Assignment (20%)**
- **Attendance and Participation (10%)**
- **Final Exam or Research Essay (40%)** focusing on a chosen Ethiopian Church Father or a specific theological theme.

6. Attendance Policy

Students are expected to attend all classes. Excessive absences may result in a lower grade or withdrawal from the course.

7. Course Resources:

7.1 Required:

- Module composed by the instructor
- Aymro, W. Joachim M. (1970). *The Ethiopian Orthodox Church*. Addis Ababa: Berhanina Selam Printing Press.
- **የኢትዮጵያ ኦርቶዶክስ ተዋህዶ ቤተክርስቲያን ለሥርዓተ አምልኮ የምትጠቀምባቸው መጻሕፍትና ለዶግማ ምንጭ የሆኑት መጻሕፍት በሙሉ ለትምህርቱ ግብዓት ይውላሉ**

7.2 Recommended:

- Cunningham, Mary B., & Theokritoff, Elizabeth (Eds.). (2008). *The Cambridge Companion to Orthodox Christian Theology*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Dumitru Staniloae (2005). *Orthodox Dogmatic Theology: The Experience of God*. Brookline, MA: Holy Cross Orthodox Press.
- Lossky, Vladimir (1978). *Orthodox Theology: An Introduction*. Crestwood, NY: St. Vladimir's Seminary Press.
- Lossky, Vladimir (1997). *The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Church*. Crestwood, NY: St. Vladimir's Seminary Press.
- Ware, Kallistos (1995). *The Orthodox Way* (Revised edition). Crestwood, NY: St. Vladimir's Seminary Press.

7.3 Additional Recommended Resources:

7.3.1 Ethiopian Orthodox Theology:

- Mebratu Kiros (2010). *The Formation of Ethiopian Orthodox Christology*. Addis Ababa University Press.
- Tesfa Mikael Tasew (2014). *Ethiopian Orthodox Theology: A Systematic Approach*. Addis Ababa University Press.
- Solomon Mushega Negash (2002). *The Ethiopian Orthodox Church: A Historical Overview*. Addis Ababa University Press.
- **ሊቀ ሥልጣናት ሀብተ ማርያም ወርቅነህ እና ሌሎች ፣** 1965. **አምስቱ ጸዋትወ ዜማዎች ፣ አዲስ አበባ**.
- **ሊቀ መዘምራን ሞገስ ሥዩም** 2009. **ታላቁ ኢትዮጵያዊ ሊቅ ቅዱስ ያሬድ ፣ ዋሺንግተን ዲሲ**.
- **ምኑን በጎበ ሰብእ** 2014. **አምስቱ አዕማደ ምሥጢር ከኡ ማተሚያ ቤት**

- መምህር ፀሐዬ ዴዲማስ 2011. ትምህርተ ድኅነት በቅዱስ ያሬድ ድርሰት አዲስ አበባ ኢትዮጵያ ከኑ ማተሚያ ቤት
- ..... 1997 የኢትዮጵያ ቤተክርስቲያን የውጪ ግንኙነት ትናትና ዛሬ በዓለም መድረክ አዲስ አበባ ኢትዮጵያ
- ..... 1959 መጽሐፈ አርጋኖን ዘአባ ጊዮርጊስ አዲስ አበባ
- መልአከ ብርሃን አድማሱ ጀምበሬ 2011. መድሎተ አሚን ፣ አዲስ አበባ ጃጃው ማተሚያ ቤት
- ..... 1988. መጽሐፈ ቅዳሴ ከቀድሞ አባቶች ሲወርድ የመጣው ንባቡና ትርጓሜው ትንሣኤ ማተሚያ ድርጅት
- ሊቀ ሊቃውንት ዕዝራ ሐዲስ 2008 ድርሳነ ቄርሎስ ወጳላዲዮስ ጎንደር
- ሊቀመዘምራን ሞገስ ዕቁበጊዮርጊስ 1988. መርሐጽድቅ ባህለ ሃይማኖት አዲስ አበባ ትንሣኤ ዘጉባኤ ማተሚያ ቤት
- ስቡሕ አዳምጤ 1997. ሺህ ዓመትና ሀሳዊ መሲህ ጥቁር አባይ ማተሚያ ቤት
- መልአከ ብርሃን አድማሱ ጀምበሬ ፳፻፫. ኩሉሐ ሃይማኖት አዲስ አበባ ዝኅራ መጽሐፍት
- መምህር ተስፋሚካኤል ታከለ 2004. የግእዝ ትርጉም ፣ ርቱዓ ሃይማኖት . አዲስ አበባ
- መምህር ግርማ ባቱ 2014. የኢትዮጵያ ቤተክርስቲያን ታሪክ ከጥንት እስከ 6ኛ ክፍለ ዘመን ቅጽ 1 አዲስ አበባ ኢትዮጵያ ጃጃው ማተሚያ ቤት
- መርጌታ ልሳነወርቅ ገብረ ኢየሱስ ፣ 1989. ጥንታዊ ሥርዓተ ማኅሌት ዘአቡነ ያሬድ ሊቅ ፣ አዲ አበባ
- መጋቤ ምሥጢር ቡሩክ ጌታቸው ፣ 2015. ጾመ ድጓ ዘቅዱስ ያሬድ አዲስ አበባ ጃጃው ማተሚያ ቤት

- **መጽሐፈ ምዕላድ (ዘርዐ ያዕቆብ)**
- **መጽሐፈ ብርሃን (ዘርዐ ያዕቆብ)**
- **ቀሲስ ዶክተር መብራቱ ኪሮስ ፣** 2012. **አኩቴተ ቁርባን አዲስ አበባ ፣ ጃጃው ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **ቀሲስ ዶክተር አምሳሉ ተፈራ** 2011. **ነቅዐ መጻሕፍት ፣ አዲስ አበባ ጃጃው ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **አባ ጊዮርጊስ ዘጋስጫ** 2001. **መጽሐፈ ምሥጢር አዲስ አበባ ኢትዮጵያ ብሔራዊ ቤተ መዛግብት ኤጀንሲ ፣ ብርሃንና ሰላም ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **አባ ጎርጎርዮስ ሊቀ ጳጳሳት** 1991 **፣ የኢትዮጵያ ቤተክርስቲያን ታሪክ ትንሣኤ ዘጉባኤ ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **የኢትዮጵያ ኦርቶዶክስ ተዋሕዶ ቤተ ክርስቲያን ታሪክ ከልደተ ክርስቶስ እስከ** 2000 **ዓ.ም አዲስ አበባ**
- **ዲያቆን ያረጋል አበጋዝ** 2007 **መድሎተ ጽድቅ አዲስ አበባ**
- **ጌታቸው ኃይሌ ፣** 2008. **ግዕዝ በቀላሉ ከናሙና ድርሰቶቹ ጋር ፣ አዲስ አበባ**
- **ጌታቸው ኃይሌ** 2012 **፣ ብዙ አፍታ ቆይታ ከግዕዝ ሥነ ጽሑፍ ጋር ፣ አዲስ አበባ ጃጃው ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **መጋቤ ሃይማኖት ቀሲስ አንዱዓለም ዳግማዊ** 2015 **፣ ወላዲ አምላክ በነገረ ድኅነት ፤ አዲስ አበባ ኢትዮጵያ ፤ ማይቢቲ ማተሚያ ቤት**

7.3.2 Patristics:

- Jaroslav Pelikan (1973). *The Development of Christian Theology*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- John Meyendorff (1987). *The Orthodox Church: Its Character, Its Development, Its Spirituality*. Crestwood, NY: St. Vladimir's Seminary Press.

- Philip Schaff (1889). *The Nicene Creed: Its History and Its Creeds*. New York: American Tract Society.
- **ሃይማኖተ ፡ አበው ፡** (1986) **ትንሣኤ ማሳተሚያ ድርጅት ፤ ትንሣኤ ዘጉባኤ ማተሚያ ቤት ።። አዲስ አበባ ።።**
- **አምሳሉ ተፈራ ፣** 2011. **ነቅዐ መጻሕፍት አዲ አበባ ፣ ጃጃው ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **አባ ሕዝቅኤል ፣** 2014. **የሃይማኖት መሠረት ፣ አዲስ አበባ ኢትዮ ፋኅስ መጻፍት ማዕከል**

7.3.3 Ethiopic Studies:

- Harold Marcus (1994). *The History of Ethiopia*. Lawrenceville, NJ: Lawrenceville Press.
- Richard Pankhurst (1961). *The Ethiopians: A History*. London: James Currey.
- **ሊቀ ሥልጣናት ሀብተ ማርያም ወርቅነህ ፣** 1963. **ጥንታዊ የኢትዮጵያ ትምህርት አዲስ አበባ ብርሃንና ሰላም ቀዳማዊ ኃይለ ሥላሴ ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **ዲያቆን ሰሎሞን ዮሐንስ ፣** 2001. **የኢትዮጵያ ቤተክርስቲያን ወርቃማ ዘመናት ፣ አዲስ አበባ ባናዊ ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **ብላቴን ጌታ ኅሩይ ኃይለ ሥላሴ ፣** 1999. **የኢትዮጵያ ታሪክ ከንግሥተ ሳባ እስከ አድዋ ፣ አዲስ አበባ ሴንትራል ማተሚያ ቤት**
- **ሉሌ መልአኩ** 1998 **፣ የቤተክርስቲያን ታሪክ ፣ አዲስ አበባ ትንሣኤ ማተሚያ ቤት**